

Invasive Plants in Pennsylvania

Japanese Angelica Tree

Aralia elata



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Background:

Japanese angelica tree is native to Japan, Korea, Manchuria and far eastern Russia. It was first introduced in 1830 as an

Description:

This is an upright deciduous shrub or tree that can reach heights of 40 feet, with a spreading, multi-stemmed form. Thick stems and the trunk have sharp prickles and spines. The leaves are bi- or tri-pinnately compound with pubescence underneath. Cream white flowers in large panicles appear in late summer and ripen into small purplish-black fruits.

Biology and Spread:

Records of the North American native *Aralia spinosa* in Maryland and Delaware are now thought to have really been *Aralia elata*.

Japanese angelica tree acts aggressively by sprouting from root sprouts, forming large competitive thickets. It spreads into uninvaded areas through bird dispersal of the berries.